

STARTING FROM SCRATCH IN LAST DANCE

In what could be his last tournament, England manager Gareth Southgate, with a **youthful squad led by Jude Bellingham**, faces strong challenges from Denmark, Serbia, and Slovenia in its group.

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England manager Gareth Southgate (**right**) came closest to Sir Alf Ramsey in guiding the Three Lions to a major trophy, as his side reached the final of the Euros three years ago.

At the time of writing, Southgate has chosen a young provisional squad before the tournament, with James Trafford, Jarrad Branthwaite, Jarell Quansah, Curtis Jones and Adam Wharton getting their maiden England call-ups.

It's a move he is desperate to get right, given that Euro 2024 might be his last dance as manager.

The Three Lions, drawn with Denmark, Slovenia, and Serbia in Group C, will look to Jude Bellingham

— the La Liga Player of the Year — as a perennial source of attack behind Kane, along with Phil Foden and Bukayo Saka.

Having made his Euro debut at 17 years and 349 days in Euro 2020, Bellingham (26 goals, 15 assists for club and national team in the 2023-24 season) is now one of the best players in Europe.

England has opted for a set-piece approach against counter-attacking sides (Brazil, Belgium) and chosen grounded passes against physically imposing sides (Italy, North

Macedonia).

With Southgate experimenting with 4-2-3-1 and 4-3-3, the latter would come in handy against Serbia and Slovenia, whose defenders have an average height of over 180 cm.

The former, on the other hand, can offer a panacea against Denmark, which will have Pierre-Emile Hojbjerg working as a pivot to set the course of counterattacks behind Christian Eriksen and Rasmus Hojlund.

England's biggest problem in defence has been leaking goals while playing a high line — something that has kept it winless since last November — with a loss to Brazil and a draw each with Belgium and Macedonia.

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